

100 Days of Azure DevOps

Day 8 Handout — A shared checklist so 'works on my machine' stops being a personality trait

1 - Azure & DevOps Foundations · Personal lab only · Educational content · Not a sales pitch

Architecture A — Test Plans object model

Object	What it is	Lab name
Test Plan	Container for a milestone / sprint	Day08 Smoke
Test Suite (static)	Hand-picked cases	Portal checks
Requirement-based suite	Auto from a User Story	Optional: suite from Day 7 story
Query-based suite	WIQL of test cases	Skip until you have 10+ cases
Test Case (work item)	Steps: Action + Expected Result	Login to Portal; Create RG via CLI
Test Run / Test Point	Outcome: Passed, Failed, Blocked, Not executed	Web runner, not a pipeline yet
Bug from fail	Work item linked to the run	File only if a step actually fails

Architecture B — when Test Plans vs tests in CI

Kind	Where it runs	Choose it when
Unit / lint	Pipeline task (dotnet test, npm test)	Every commit; milliseconds-minutes
API / UI automation	Pipeline or dedicated agent	Regression you can script
Manual Test Case	Test Plans web runner	UAT, portal clicks, exploratory charter
Exploratory session	Test & Feedback / exploratory testing	You do not know the steps yet
Traceability	Story ↔ Test Case ↔ Run ↔ Bug	Audit: did this story get proven?
Do not	Excel on a laptop named TestPlan_vFinal	Nobody else can execute it

Architecture C — pitfalls that make Test Plans a graveyard

Pitfall	What you see	Fix
SKU wall	Test Plans hub empty / paywall	Basic + Test Plans trial, or Visual Studio subscriber; do not use work license
Cases with no steps	Title only, runner is guesswork	Action + Expected on every step
Never run	100 cases, 0 outcomes	Execute two cases today; mark Pass/Blocked
No link to Boards	Cannot answer 'is the story tested?'	Add link → User Story from Day 7
Blocked without reason	Outcome Blocked, empty comment	Comment: missing personal sub / CLI not installed
Automate later = never	Manual forever for unit-level checks	Phase 3: put scriptable tests in YAML

One-liner to remember

Automated tests verify what you expected. Test Plans track what a human must still prove.

Step-by-step lab (personal Azure / Azure DevOps only)

Project azure-100-labs. Enable Test Plans on the personal org if the hub asks (trial / included SKU). No work Visual Studio license.

- 1 azure-100-labs → Test Plans. If prompted, start the Test Plans trial on this personal org only.
- 2 New Test Plan → Name Day08 Smoke → Area = default team. Create.
- 3 Add suite → Static suite → Portal checks.
- 4 New Test Case: Login to Portal. Steps: (1) Open portal.azure.com (2) Confirm personal directory. Expected: subscription visible, no work tenant.
- 5 New Test Case: Create RG via CLI. Steps: az group create -n rg-day08-smoke -l centralindia then az group delete -n rg-day08-smoke --yes --no-wait.
- 6 Run for web application → mark Login Passed. Mark CLI case Passed or Blocked with a comment if az is missing.
- 7 Open the test case → Links → add User Story Explore Azure Test Plans (Day 7). Boards should show the test link.

Test case steps (paste into the web runner) plus the CLI under test

```
# TC: Login to Portal
# 1. Open portal.azure.com
# 2. Directory picker = personal Microsoft account
# Expected: subscription name + ID visible; no work tenant

# TC: Create RG via CLI
az group create --name rg-day08-smoke --location centralindia
az group show --name rg-day08-smoke --query location -o tsv
az group delete --name rg-day08-smoke --yes --no-wait
```

Done checklist

- Can explain Test Plan vs Suite vs Case vs Run
- Day08 Smoke exists with two cases and at least one executed outcome
- One case linked to a Boards User Story
- No work-org Test Plans used

Tomorrow — Day 9

Azure Artifacts